



Digital Malawi Acceleration Project

GRANT: IDA-E338-MW
PROJECT NUMBER: P505095

Request for Proposals Information Systems

Design, Supply and Installation
(With or Without Prequalification)

Procurement of: Provision of a turnkey solution for the rehabilitation, upgrading, and commissioning of the Central Printing Facility including design, supply, installation and handover for full operational readiness

Purchaser:	The Public Private Partnership Commission
Project:	Digital Malawi Acceleration Project
Contract title:	Provision of a turnkey solution for the rehabilitation, upgrading, and commissioning of the Central Printing Facility including design, supply, installation and handover for full operational readiness
Country:	Malawi
Grant No.:	IDA-E338-MW
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Addendum No. 2 to the Request for Proposal Document

Following request for clarifications on technical specifications, the Request for Proposal (RFP) is amended as follows:

A. Section VII – Requirements of the Supply, Installation and Commissioning of a Polycarbonate (PC) Cards, Personalization and Mailing Systems is amended to read as follows:

(a) Paragraph 1.5.2.4.1: Card Personalization Transactions is amended to read as follows:

- Card encoding transactions (magnetic/laser engraving)
- Card printing transactions
- Card re-issuance and reprint transactions

(b) Paragraph 2.1.4.3.1 is amended to read as follows:

2.1.4.3.1 The system shall:

- Generate card personalization data
- Produce card layouts
- Print visual information
- Laser engrave card information
- Encode barcode data (where applicable)

(c) Annexes

Table A: Schedule of the Pre-Commissioning Tests – (4.2. 2) is amended as follows:

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Details	Deliverables
1	Physical Installation Verification Tests	To verify that all equipment has been installed in accordance with approved designs and manufacturer's specifications.	• Verification of equipment placement and layout. • Verification of equipment anchoring and stability. • Inspection of cable management and labelling. • Verification of rack installations. • Verification of workstation installations. • Verification of safety clearances around equipment.	Physical Installation Verification Report.
2	Electrical Power Tests	To confirm the adequacy and stability of electrical systems supporting the personalization facility.	• Utility power verification. • UPS functionality testing. • Power distribution testing. • Load testing of power circuits. • Automatic transfer switch testing. • Earthing/grounding tests. • Voltage and frequency stability measurements.	Electrical Systems Test Report.
3	Environmental Systems Tests	To verify environmental readiness of the personalization facility.	HVAC Testing: • Temperature control verification. • Humidity control verification. • Airflow testing. Fire Detection and Suppression Testing: • Smoke detector functionality. • Alarm activation. • Suppression system readiness. Water Leakage Detection: • Sensor functionality testing.	Environmental Systems Readiness Report.
4	Network Infrastructure Tests	To verify network readiness and connectivity.	• LAN connectivity testing. • WAN connectivity testing. • Network redundancy testing. • Switch and router functionality testing.	Network Acceptance Report.

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Details	Deliverables
			• Network throughput testing. • Network latency testing. • VLAN verification. • DNS and DHCP testing.	
5	Cybersecurity and Access Control Tests	To verify that the personalization environment is secure.	User Authentication: • Active Directory integration. • Role-based access control verification. • Password policy testing. Security Controls: • Firewall rule verification. • Anti-malware verification. • Endpoint security testing. Audit Logging: • Log generation verification. • Event monitoring verification.	Security Readiness Report.
6	Personalization Equipment Functional Tests	To verify operational readiness of card personalization equipment.	Card Feeding Tests: • Hopper loading. • Automatic feeding. Laser Engraving Tests: • Image engraving. • Text engraving. • Variable data engraving. Printing Tests: • Print alignment. • Colour consistency. • Print quality.	Equipment Functional Test Report.

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Details	Deliverables
			Encoding Tests (if applicable): - Barcode encoding. - QR code encoding.	
7	Mailing System Functional Tests	To verify operational readiness of mailing equipment.	- Envelope feeding. - Envelope insertion. - Address printing. - Sorting functionality. - Batch processing functionality.	Mailing System Functional Test Report.
8	Software Installation and Configuration Tests	To verify that all software components are properly configured.	- Operating system verification. - Database installation verification. - Application installation verification. - License verification. - Backup configuration verification. - Monitoring tools verification.	Software Readiness Report.
9	NRIS Integration Tests	To verify connectivity and interoperability with the National Registration and Identification System (NRIS).	Interface Connectivity: - API connectivity testing. - Web service connectivity testing. - Secure communication verification. Data Exchange Tests: - Demographic data retrieval. - Photograph retrieval. - Signature image retrieval. - Production status updates. Error Handling Tests: - Invalid record handling. - Missing data handling. - Communication failure recovery.	NRIS Integration Test Report.
10	Data Validation and Integrity Tests	To verify integrity of data exchanged between systems.	- Field mapping verification. - Data transformation verification. - Character encoding verification. - Data completeness checks.	Data Integrity Verification Report.

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Details	Deliverables
			• Duplicate record detection.	
11	Security Feature Verification Tests	To verify implementation of card security features.	• Laser engraving quality. • Ghost image verification. • Microtext verification. • Guilloche pattern verification. • Security background verification. • UV feature verification. • Machine-readable element verification.	Card Security Features Verification Report.
12	Quality Control System Tests	To verify card quality inspection systems.	• Automated inspection functionality. • Defect detection. • OCR verification. • Barcode verification. • Image quality verification.	Quality Assurance Test Report.
13	Backup and Recovery Tests	To verify system resilience and recoverability.	• Backup execution testing. • Database restoration testing. • Configuration restoration testing. • Disaster recovery procedures testing.	Backup and Recovery Test Report.
14	Production Workflow Simulation Tests	To verify complete end-to-end workflow operation.	The bidder shall simulate: • Citizen record extraction from NRIS. • Card production job generation. • Card personalization. • Quality inspection. • Card mailing preparation. • Dispatch generation. • Status update to NRIS	Workflow Simulation Report.
15	Pilot Production Readiness Tests	To verify readiness for pilot production.	The bidder shall successfully produce a minimum number of test cards (e.g., 500–1,000 cards) using actual production processes. • Verification shall include: • Data accuracy. • Print quality. • Engraving quality. • Mailing functionality. • Reporting functionality.	Pilot Production Readiness Report.

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Details	Deliverables
16	Performance and Capacity Tests	To verify that the solution can meet required production volumes.	The bidder shall demonstrate: • Sustained card production rates. • Peak production capability. • Batch processing capability. • Mailing throughput capability.	Capacity and Performance Test Report.

Table B: Schedule of the Operational Acceptance Tests (4.3. 2) is amended as follows:

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Conditions	Success Criteria
1	End-to-End Operational Workflow Test	To confirm full operational readiness of the complete ID card lifecycle.	- NRIS fully integrated and operational in production environment - Personalization and mailing systems installed and commissioned - Live or production-like approved citizen records available - All subsystems (hardware, software, security, network) operational	100% of test records processed end-to-end without manual intervention - Successful flow from NRIS → personalization → QC → mailing → dispatch → status update - Accurate status updates reflected in NRIS - Full audit trail available for each transaction
2	Sustained Production Stability Test	To validate system stability under continuous real operational use.	- Production environment fully operational - Real consumables and live configuration used - Normal staffing levels in place	- System operates continuously for a minimum defined period (e.g., 5–10 working days) - System availability $\geq 99\%$ during test period - No critical or severity 1 failures - No unplanned production stoppage due to system failure
3	Production Throughput Compliance Test	To confirm that the system meets contractual production capacity requirements.	- Full system configuration deployed - Representative production batch loaded	- Achieved throughput $\geq$ contractual minimum (cards/hour and mail items/hour) - No backlog accumulation under steady-state load - Processing queues remain within defined thresholds - Consistent output over sustained period
4	Peak Load Operational Test	To validate system behaviour under peak demand conditions.	- Simulated peak production workload applied - All system components operating simultaneously	- No system crashes or failures - No data loss or corruption - System response time remains within acceptable operational thresholds - Throughput remains $\geq 95\%$ of nominal capacity under peak load
5	Data Accuracy and Integrity Test (Live Operations)	To ensure correctness of all data processed in live operations.	- Real NRIS data used - Production jobs executed	$\geq 99.99\%$ accuracy of demographic and biometric data on cards - No mismatch between NRIS source data and printed/encoded output - No loss or duplication of records - Consistent data integrity across all subsystems

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Conditions	Success Criteria
6	NRIS Business Process Integration Test	To validate operational interoperability with NRIS.	- NRIS integration active in production mode - Live transactions enabled	- Successful execution of all business transactions: - New issuance - Reprint requests - Replacement cards - Lost/damaged card processing - Real-time status updates reflected in NRIS - No failed or orphaned transactions
7	Card Quality and Security Compliance Test	To verify production output meets national identity security standards.	- Production card stock and security materials in use - Approved design templates applied	100% compliance with approved card design specifications - Security features (laser engraving, microtext, UV, etc.) correctly applied - Reject rate $\leq 1\%$ - Machine-readable features fully functional (barcode/QR if applicable)
8	Mailing and Dispatch Operations Test	To validate operational readiness of mailing subsystem.	- Mailing system fully integrated with personalization system - Production mailing batches available	$\geq 99.5\%$ accuracy in mail insertion and addressing - No duplicate or missing mail items - Correct matching of card-to-envelope-to-recipient - Dispatch records correctly generated and stored
9	Audit Trail and Traceability Test	To ensure full traceability of all operational activities.	- Audit logging enabled across all systems - Live transactions executed	100% traceability of each card from NRIS record to dispatch - All user actions logged (operator, supervisor, admin) - System events and exceptions logged and retrievable - Audit logs tamper-proof and secure
10	Security Operations Test	To validate operational cybersecurity controls.	- Role-based access control configured - Security policies active	- Only authorised users can access defined functions - Failed login attempts logged and alerted - No privilege escalation possible - All security events logged and monitored - No critical vulnerabilities identified during operation
11	Backup, Restore and Recovery Operations Test	To confirm operational resilience of the system.	Backup systems configured and scheduled	- Successful backup execution during live operation - Successful restoration of data without corruption - No significant disruption to production operations
12	Monitoring and Alerting Operational Test	To ensure operational visibility and incident response readiness.	Monitoring tools and dashboards configured	- Alerts generated for system failures, performance degradation, and consumable thresholds - Alerts successfully received by operators in real time - Monitoring dashboards reflect real-time system status - Logs and metrics available for troubleshooting

No	Type of Test	Objective	Test Conditions	Success Criteria
13	Multi-Shift Operational Test	To validate system performance under real staffing conditions.	- At least two operator shifts engaged - Handover procedures executed	- No disruption during shift handover - Consistent throughput across shifts - No dependency on vendor presence for operations - Operators able to independently manage system
14	Consumables and Inventory Management Test	To ensure operational continuity of supplies.	Live consumables used in production	- Accurate tracking of consumables usage - Automated alerts for low stock levels - No production stoppage due to inventory failures - Inventory reports accurate and real-time
15	Operational Reporting and SLA Compliance Test	To validate reporting capability and service level compliance.	Production data generated over operational period	- Accurate daily, weekly, and monthly reports generated - SLA metrics correctly calculated (uptime, throughput, rejection rate) - Reports available to authorized users on demand - No discrepancies between system logs and reports
16	Operational Independence Test (Knowledge Transfer Validation)	To confirm Purchaser can operate system without vendor dependency.	- Training completed for Purchaser staff - Vendor support limited to observation only	- Purchaser staff independently operate full system - All routine operational tasks performed without vendor intervention - Troubleshooting of minor issues handled by trained staff - Operational manuals validated and usable
17	Final Operational Acceptance Demonstration Test	To formally confirm readiness for full production rollout.	- All prior OATs successfully completed - System running in production environment	- Continuous successful production over agreed observation period (e.g., 10–30 days) - All KPIs met: - System availability $\geq 99\%$ - Data accuracy $\geq 99.99\%$ - Card reject rate $\leq 1\%$ - Mailing accuracy $\geq 99.5\%$ - Full NRIS integration operational - No critical unresolved defects - Purchaser formally accepts operational readiness

(d) Background and Informational Materials; Paragraph 0.4.7.5 is amended to read as follows:

0.4.7.5 Identity Card Personalization System which is responsible for personalizing identity cards, printing cardholder details, applying security features and managing card production workflows.

(e) Paragraph 3.2.2 Marking Resolution Requirements is amended as follows:

3.2.2.1 The laser marking engine shall support the following minimum resolutions:

3.2.2.1.1 Picture: 600 dpi or higher in greyscale.

3.2.2.1.2 Micro text: 600 dpi or higher and a line width and height of 0.33mm

B. Section III – Evaluation and Qualification Criteria

1.4 Subcontractors/vendors/manufacturers is amended as follows:

Subcontractors for the following additional major items of supply or services must meet or continue to meet the minimum criteria specified therein for each item:

Item No	Description of Item	Minimum criteria to be met
1	Rehabilitation of Card Production Facility	Must meet the following requirements: • Registered contractor with Construction Industry Regulatory Authority (CIRA) in Malawi • Subcontractor should deploy key personnel meeting the requirements set in Section VII under 2.4. • Verifiable reference as a Prime Contractor or Subcontractor or Joint Venture member of at least three (3) completed relevant renovations within the past five (5) years • The subcontractor must have access to (owned or leased) the following minimum equipment: i. Personal Protective Equipment ii. Drywall Partitioning Equipment iii. Electrical Installation Equipment iv. Lifting Equipment
2	Supply of Polycarbonate Cards	Must meet the following requirements • Be the OEM of the offered Polycarbonate cards. • Have a valid ISO 27001, ISO 9001, ISO 14001 certifications. • Have a 10-year lifespan minimum ISO24789 • Have OVMI Malawi flag motif • Stacked-Layer greyscale personalization • Have a high-resolution portrait (600+ dpi) • Own at least one (1) manufacturing sites capable of producing polycarbonate cards with advanced security features. • Have within its own manufacturing sites a card production capacity of up to fifty (50) million cards per year • Have at least two (2) National Identity references for the supply of at least five (5) million polycarbonate cards. In total five (5) million cards collectively (Letter of References or Purchase Orders will be required).

Item No	Description of Item	Minimum criteria to be met
		Be responsible to provide five thousand (5,000) sample Cards/specimen free of charge (FOC) as per the approved design for laser personalization machine testing. The successful bidder shall provide undertaking on letter head for FOC cards.

Bidders are advised that all other details of the Request for Proposal remain unchanged unless revised through Addenda 1 and 2 issued.

IPDC Chairperson